

Freelancer Invoice & Billing Automation

Version: 1.0 (Phase 1)

Category: Finance Automation

Estimated Setup Time: 10–15 Minutes

Overview

This workflow automates invoice generation from a single webhook request. It generates a professional HTML invoice, converts it to PDF using PDFShift, uploads the PDF to Google Drive, stores invoice metadata in Google Sheets, and emails the invoice to the client.

Workflow

Webhook → Client & Invoice Details → Generate Invoice Number → Calculate Totals → Generate HTML → PDFShift → Google Drive Upload → Merge Data → Google Sheets → Gmail

Features

- Automatic invoice number generation
- Automatic subtotal, tax and total calculation
- Professional HTML invoice generation
- PDF generation using PDFShift
- Google Drive backup
- Google Sheets invoice tracking
- Automatic email delivery with PDF attachment

Prerequisites

Service	Purpose
n8n	Workflow execution
PDFShift	HTML to PDF conversion
Google Drive	Store generated invoices
Google Sheets	Track invoices
Gmail	Send invoice emails

Webhook Input

Expected JSON fields:

clientName

email

company

items[]

currency

invoiceDate

dueDate
tax
notes

Node Documentation

1. Invoice Request

Receives invoice data via POST webhook.

2. Client & Invoice Details

Normalizes incoming payload and keeps required fields.

3. Generate Invoice Number

Creates invoice number in INV-YYYYMMDD-XXXX format.

4. Calculate Invoice Totals

Calculates subtotal, taxAmount and total.

5. Generate Invoice HTML

Builds the complete HTML invoice with branding.

6. Generate PDF Invoice

HTTP Request → PDFShift.

Method: POST

URL: <https://api.pdfshift.io/v3/convert/pdf>

Headers: Content-Type: application/json, Authorization: Bearer <API_KEY>

Body: source = {{\$json.html}}

Response Format: File

7. Upload Invoice to Google Drive

Upload binary PDF (property: data) to the Invoices folder.

8. Merge Invoice & Drive Data

Merge original invoice data with Google Drive response by position.

9. Save Invoice Record

Append a row to Google Sheets with invoice details, Drive file ID and links.

10. Send Invoice Email

Send invoice email with PDF attachment and Drive link.

Google Sheets Columns

- Invoice Number
- Client Name

- Company
- Email
- Currency
- Amount
- Tax
- Tax Amount
- Subtotal
- Invoice Date
- Due Date
- Status
- Reminder Count
- PDF Name
- Google Drive File ID
- Drive View Link
- Drive Download Link
- Created At

Outputs

- Professional PDF Invoice
- Google Drive Backup
- Google Sheets Record
- Invoice Email Delivered

Troubleshooting

- PDF not generated: Verify PDFShift API key and HTTP Request configuration.
- Drive upload failed: Check Google Drive OAuth and folder permissions.
- Google Sheets error: Verify Spreadsheet ID, sheet name and column headers.
- Email failed: Check Gmail OAuth and recipient email.

Phase 2 Roadmap

- Payment Tracking
- Reminder Emails
- WhatsApp Notifications
- Stripe/Razorpay Integration
- Analytics Dashboard
- Recurring Invoices
- AI Follow-up Messages

About Shinka-6C

This workflow is part of the Shinka-6C Workflow Collection. It is designed as a production-ready n8n automation template that users can import, configure, and deploy quickly.